

**COMP 3700A: Contributing to Open Source**

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# Introduction

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# Who am I?

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**Name:** Charlotte Curtis

**Pronouns:** She/her

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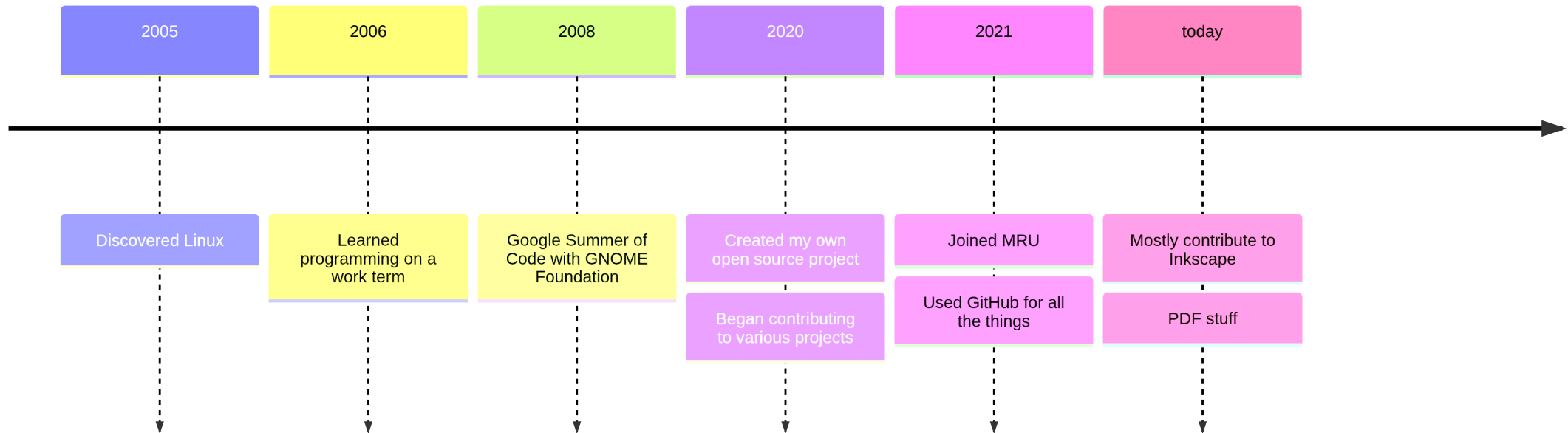
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**Office hours:** [Book here](#)



# My history with open source

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*I still have a lot to learn!*



*Who are you?*

# Course content

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- Some technical content on common tools and workflows, including git, forking and merging, yaml, markdown, grep
- The various roles and organizational structures of OSS projects
- Licensing and ownership
- Release cycles and continuous integration/deployment (CI/CD)
- Non code contributions
- Funding models

*Probably some more things that I've forgotten*

# Deliverables

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| Component              | Weight |
|------------------------|--------|
| Lab activities         | 14%    |
| Class participation    | 21%    |
| Midterm (Oct 28)       | 15%    |
| Term project (3 parts) | 50%    |

- Midterm is the only exam
- Term project: contributing to a community of your choice
- Lots of discussion and sharing back to the class (3x presentations)
- Class participation includes contributing to course repo

# What is Open Source?

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You might see the terms:

- Free software
- Free open source software (FOSS)
- Free/libre open source software (FLOSS)
- Humanitarian free open source software (HFOSS)
- Open hardware
- Open educational resources
- and probably more!

# Free as in freedom, not as in beer

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Four essential freedoms, according to the [Free Software Foundation](#):

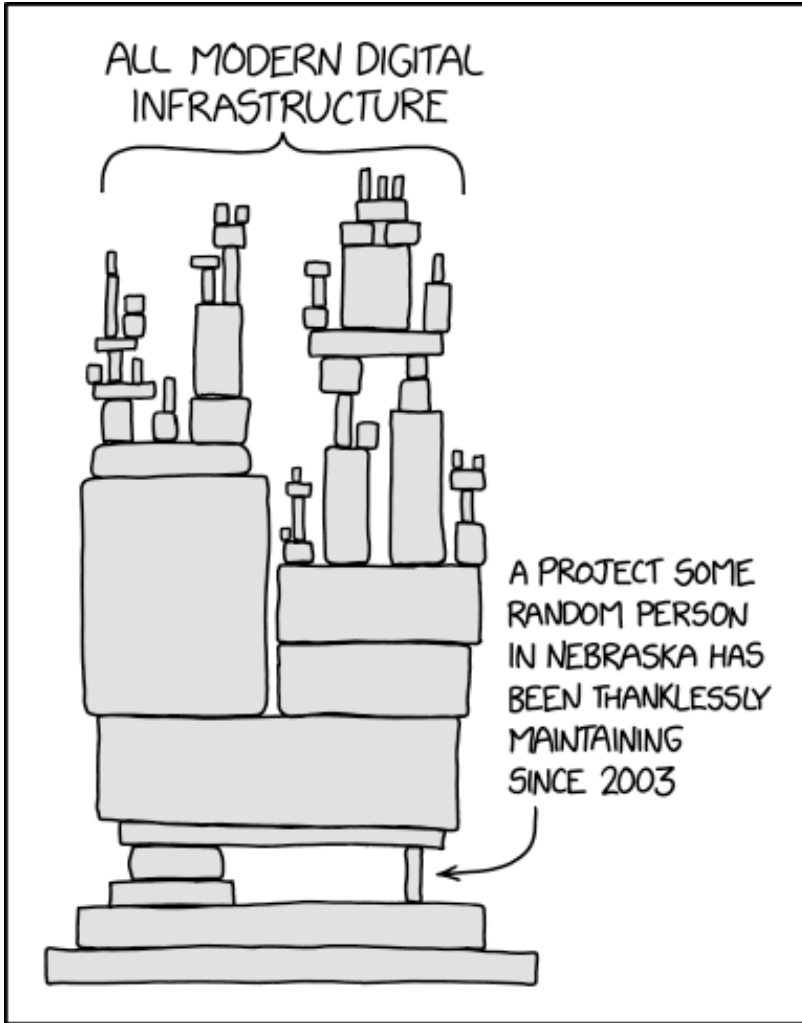
0. **Run** the program as you wish
1. **Study** and **change** the program
2. **Redistribute copies**
3. Distribute your **modified versions**

*The [Open Source Definition](#) is somewhat looser, but essentially the same  
"Free" does not refer to cost!*

# Why open source?



- More eyes -> more bugfixes
- Transparency -> better security
- Control over your own software
- Learning from others



# Why this course?

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This course aims to provide:

- Exposure to real-world teams, projects, code, policies, procedures, etc
- Messy codebases
- Time and space to fail, learn, and contribute

*Ultimate goal is to break down barriers*



*What are some barriers to contributing to open source?*

# Where can you find OSS?

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- You use it every day!
- Check out <https://awesomeopensource.com>
- Popular hosting platforms include:
  - [GitHub](#)
  - [GitLab](#)
  - [CodeBerg](#)
  - even email, such as for [git](#) itself

**Homework:** for next lecture, respond to the [discussion post](#) with links to 3-5 OSS projects that you use